

that attended the Beatles' arrival at Kennedy Airport, New York, in February 1964.

Airlines wanted flight to be sexy and fun. The alluring "air hostess" became a key weapon in the battle to fill seats. American company Braniff captured the mood in 1965 when it announced "the End of the Plain Plane." All its aircraft were painted in one of seven garishly bright colors – the press dubbed them the "jelly bean fleet" – and female flight attendants were fitted out in outrageous outfits designed by Italian fashion guru Emilio Pucci. One Braniff advertising punchline was: "Does your wife know you are

flying with us?" The exploitation of sex appeal reached its apogee in a National Airlines advertising campaign in 1971, which grabbed the attention of potential passengers with a picture of a young flight attendant and the slogan: "I'm Linda. Fly me." This was extreme, but all airlines agreed that flight attendants should be female, young, and have a good figure. It was, no doubt, the spirit of the age.

#### THE BEATLES DISCOVER AMERICA

*Arriving at New York's Kennedy Airport on Pan Am Flight 101 in February 1964, the Beatles were greeted by thousands of hysterical fans. Given the glamour and novelty of jet flight, airports seemed an apt location for the celebration of star status.*

